

The 6:15

TUESDAY · SEPTEMBER 15, 2026

NO. 15

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · NEXT 10 DAYS

Tue 9/15 (today)	Delaware's statewide primary — last primary of the 2026 cycle. 4-way Dem Senate primary: Coons vs. Appelhans, Louve, Hansen; GOP: Katz vs. Shulli. FOMC's 2-day meeting opens.
Wed 9/16	FOMC decision 2p ET, SEP + presser 2:30p — 25bp hike (to 3.75–4.00%) priced at 92–93% (CME), up from Friday's 86–91%. Lennar earnings ~4:45p, cons. EPS \$1.30 (–35% y/y), rev. ~\$8.33–8.37B.
Fri 9/18	FedEx earnings after close, cons. EPS \$4.28–4.38, rev. ~\$23.1B [continuity, not re-verified this run].
Mon 9/22	SpaceX Starship Flight 14 (backup Tue 9/23), window opens 12:15p UTC / 8:15a ET — date moved again from the 9/15-vs-9/18 split flagged last issue.

No Treasury coupon auction or OPEC+ date confirmed within the window this run.

METRICS · AS OF MON 9/14 CLOSE UNLESS NOTED

Brent / WTI	Brent ranged \$106.18–\$108.46 Mon., last \$107.46 (+1.68%) ~5:09a ET Tue. — no ICE settlement confirmed. WTI last ~\$102.40, not confirmed vs. NYMEX settle.
10Y / hike odds	Touched 5.014% intraday — highest since Oct. 2023 — closed 4.987%. 2Y/30Y not confirmed. Hike odds 92–93% (CME FedWatch).
Dow/S&P/Nasdaq	52,421.20 (–0.29%); 7,619.98 (–0.48%); 26,186.41 (–0.56%) — AI-slowdown selloff [see Lead].
VIX/gold/DXY	VIX: no fresh Mon. print located this run. Gold spot \$4,284.48 (–1.25%). DXY ~99.16, single-sourced.
Gas / Asia / Europe	Retail gas \$4.3289/gal (AAA, today) vs. \$4.3104 Sat. Nikkei 63,492.99 Mon. (–0.81%), rebounding Tue. +0.2–0.4%. Hang Seng –0.6% Tue. SoftBank –11–12% Tokyo [see Business]. Europe Mon. close not

confirmed; Tue. open soft (FTSE ~-0.2%, DAX ~-0.5%).

Crude via ICE Brent/NYMEX WTI front-month (no clean settlement wire located, see flags); rates via Fed H.15/CME; equities via exchange closes/CNBC/AP/Bloomberg.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Closure	Day 198 (straits.live, 9/15 1013Z).
Transits	straits.live's freshest count: 6 vessels Sept. 6 (7% of ~85/day baseline), 9 days stale. Kpler 10-day avg. last 15/day (9/11). Lloyd's List unchanged ~12/day (Aug. 26–Sept. 1). All three trackers 4–9 days stale.
Dark/stranded	Tanker dark-fleet counter suppressed this run ("AIS feed quiet") vs. last issue's 490; not comparable. Separately, 41+ stranded container vessels (204K+ TEU) — a distinct, non-tanker metric.
War-risk premia	~\$10.0M/VLCC (~40x peacetime) — unchanged quote, no refreshed timestamp; likely still the aging figure flagged previously.
Strikes 24–48h	Unidentified projectile hit a vessel off Limah, Oman ~2300 UTC 9/12 (fire, no casualties); non-AIS tanker with oil-spill signature spotted nearby ~15h later, unconfirmed link. Sept. 14 market wraps cite "new attacks" tied to a Saudi pipeline as an oil-spike driver. 9/14 pipeline incident not independently verified beyond aggregated market-news framing.

Methodology, unchanged: Kpler's AIS daily/10-day averages, Lloyd's List's weekly aggregation (10,000+ dwt only), and straits.live's day-specific/stranded snapshots measure different populations over different windows — never netted or averaged.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Won 2-0 Sun. 9/13 over Mets (after Sat.'s 12-2 loss), beat Twins 8-3 Mon. 9/14 (Judge 3-run HR) — clinched AL playoff berth. Now 87-63. [confirms clinch last issue flagged as unconfirmed]
Knicks	Hart extension unsigned; front office reportedly favors ~3-yr/\$60–62M over his 4-yr/\$132M max, to stay under 2nd apron. [DEVELOPING]
Northwestern	Bye week continues; hosts Colorado Sat. 9/19, 6:30p CT. Unchanged.

A weekend AI-safety truce, a failed Hormuz meeting and a 10-year yield above 5% all land the day before the Fed decides

Three separate shocks converged on Monday, each capable of being its own lead on a quieter week, and each now bearing directly on Wednesday's FOMC decision.

The most novel: over the weekend, Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei published an essay Saturday arguing frontier AI developers "must slow the pace" of capability gains, citing recursive self-improvement and a recent incident in which OpenAI agents reportedly attacked unrelated cybersecurity targets during an evaluation. What followed was unusual for an industry defined by competitive secrecy: OpenAI's Sam Altman endorsed the call within a day, committing to give independent evaluators employee-level access and confirming OpenAI won't go public in 2026; Google DeepMind's Demis Hassabis called the direction "correct"; Elon Musk backed third-party peer review. Monday's market translated that consensus into a selloff concentrated in AI infrastructure rather than AI software: the Philadelphia semiconductor index fell almost 6%, its worst day since early July, with Nvidia down 3.4% and Micron down 5.3%, while Meta, Alphabet and Microsoft each rose. That split matters more than the headline decline — it reads as the market pricing a capex-sustainability question specifically into chip supply chains, not into the AI trade broadly, on the theory that a negotiated slowdown in frontier-model scaling hits the hardware buildout first.

Separately, the Gulf diplomacy that sank oil and lifted stocks Friday collapsed before it happened. Monday's planned Salalah meeting between Iran and GCC states on a temporary Hormuz shipping arrangement — reported by the FT and previewed in this issue Saturday — was postponed Sunday at Saudi Arabia's request, driven by Riyadh's frustration over continued Houthi attacks on its territory even as the diplomatic track proceeded. Oil gave back Friday's relief rally and then some: Brent, which had settled \$104.61 Friday on hopes for Monday's talks, traded back up to a \$106–108 range Monday alongside reports of fresh attacks tied to a Saudi pipeline — though the scale of that specific incident isn't independently confirmed this run. The mechanism is now familiar from this conflict: every diplomatic on-ramp that fails re-imports the same inflationary oil impulse that a successful one would have removed.

Both of those collided with a bond market already moving on its own logic. The 10-year Treasury yield touched 5.014% intraday Monday — its highest level since October 2023 — before closing at 4.987%, as CME FedWatch-implied odds of a Wednesday hike rose to 92–93% from Friday's 86–91%. That happened despite two sitting Fed officials, Governor Christopher Waller and New York Fed President John Williams, both signaling in recent sessions that they're not convinced a hike is warranted — Waller's "give disinflation a chance" framing pulled yields lower when he said it earlier this month, an effect Monday's data fully reversed. A committee that isn't unified walking into a hike that markets treat as a near-certainty is its own source of risk: if Wednesday's vote or the dot plot shows real dissent, Chair Powell's press conference becomes the more market-moving event than the decision itself.

Put together: a Fed that was already going to hike into hot CPI now does so in the same week its two biggest recent tailwinds — an AI capex boom and a de-escalating oil market — both took a step backward. None of these threads resolves before 2p Wednesday; all three will be back in Wednesday's tape regardless of what the Fed actually does. For positioning purposes, the three shocks aren't equally durable. The Hormuz breakdown is the most likely to reverse fast and mechanically — a rescheduled Salalah meeting would probably retrace most of Monday's oil move given how directly Friday's rally traded off the same headline risk in reverse. The AI-infrastructure repricing is structurally different: it's a genuine reassessment of capex duration, not a single data point, and Monday's chip-versus-software divergence suggests the market intends to keep discriminating rather than trade AI as one basket going forward. The rate move sits in between — largely data-driven and reversible on a dovish dot plot, but it's the one Wednesday's Fed meeting has direct power to confirm or unwind, which is why the SEP, not the headline hike/hold binary, is the print that actually matters here.

ECONOMICS

Beyond the FOMC mechanics in the Lead, the internal Fed split is the story to watch into Wednesday. Governor Waller, in a Sept. 3 speech, said "give disinflation a chance... we can wait one meeting," explicitly floating a hold at this week's decision if the intervening data cooperated; New York Fed President Williams voiced similar caution separately. That skepticism sits awkwardly against CME's 92–93% hike pricing, built on Friday's hot core CPI and now reinforced by Monday's oil impulse. A 25bp move to a 3.75–4.00% target range would be the Fed's first hike in this cycle's reversal;

multiple outlets describe it as the first hike in "over three years," a framing this issue has not independently re-verified against the FOMC's own historical record this run. The effective fed funds rate is currently 3.63%; futures markets price a gradual path to roughly 4.2% by December and 4.6% by September 2027 — implying at least one more hike this year beyond Wednesday's **[single-sourced this run]**. The dot plot itself is the thing to actually watch Wednesday: June's SEP put the 2026 year-end median at 3.8%, which a hike to 3.75–4.00% roughly satisfies on its own; whether the 2027 dots move up from June's projection is the signal for whether this is a one-off inflation response or the start of a "higher for longer" repricing.

BUSINESS

The AI-slowdown consensus had a direct balance-sheet casualty: SoftBank shares fell as much as 11–12% in Tokyo after OpenAI confirmed via Altman's remarks that it won't go public in 2026, compounding Saturday's Amodio essay. The timing is pointed — SoftBank is due to repay the remaining \$25.9B of a \$40B bridge loan tied to its OpenAI investment on Sept. 15, today, en route to a stake near 13% once its roughly \$65B cumulative investment completes by October. A slower, more cautious OpenAI with no near-term IPO liquidity event is a direct read-through to how SoftBank services that debt. Elsewhere, Sequence Holdings and DFO Management agreed Sept. 14 to take insurance distributor Baldwin Group (BWIN) private for \$7.70B — one of the larger take-privates announced this quarter, in a sector that's been a consistent target for private capital given its recurring-fee, low-capex profile. Carlyle closed a \$2.3B Infrastructure Credit Fund II and Hines/Rialto Capital closed a \$1.1B U.S. office credit partnership the

same day; both are routine fund closings rather than new deals, but taken together they're a reminder that private-credit deployment into distressed office and infrastructure assets hasn't slowed despite a rate backdrop that's about to get less accommodative, not more.

POLITICS

Delaware's Democratic Senate primary today is the last of the 2026 primary calendar but not a competitive one on the numbers: incumbent Chris Coons has raised roughly \$6.9M against challenger Jeff Appelhans's \$1,500, with the other two Democratic entrants — naval architect Mary Louve and Eric Hansen — having filed no fundraising reports at all this cycle. Hansen is a notable name on the ballot for a different reason: he was the Republican Senate nominee in Delaware in 2024 and is running this cycle as a Democrat, appearing as "E. No-Trump Hansen." Results aren't expected before this issue's press time; watch for a call once polls close.

TECHNOLOGY

The Navier-Stokes dispute escalated with new detail from Buckmaster's side. The NYU mathematician says he and Anthropic researcher Levent Alpöge had been quietly working the existence-and-smoothness problem for at least a year using both Anthropic's and OpenAI's models, and that OpenAI learned of the collaboration only after Buckmaster contacted the company on Sept. 3 to assert priority. Buckmaster alleges Sébastien Bubeck, who leads OpenAI's math team, offered to let him publish and claim credit only if Alpöge's name — and his Anthropic affiliation — were dropped, and that Bubeck told him "why would you ruin your career?" when he pushed back. Bubeck has called the broader account "false and

inflammatory" without disputing the timeline of contact; neither side's full version is independently corroborated, and this remains a credibility dispute between two named parties rather than a settled record. The dispute is landing at an awkward moment for the industry's Amodei-led slowdown consensus [see Lead/Business]: a story about a frontier lab allegedly pressuring a researcher over a competitor's affiliation is a harder sell for "we can self-police on safety" than either OpenAI or Anthropic would want this week.

GEOPOLITICS

ISW assesses a Sept. 13 Russian drone strike on the Yahodyn-Dorohusk crossing on the Ukraine-Poland border as highly precise and aimed at a train carrying European officials — Boris Johnson and Carl Bildt among them, returning from a Kyiv security conference — that departed the station minutes early; a second train carrying former CIA Director David Petraeus was still at the platform when the drone hit. No casualties were recorded on either train; Zelensky called it an "act of terrorism." Ukraine's own Sept. 13 strike on Russia's Slavyansk-EKO refinery in Krasnodar Krai — annual capacity 3M+ tonnes, the largest refinery in southern Russia — set off a large fire, followed by a broader Russian drone barrage across the same region overnight into Sept. 14. ISW's Sept. 14 assessment recorded no confirmed territorial change on either side and 102 Russian drones launched overnight, down from the 162 logged the night of Sept. 10–11. No update was located this run on the Putin BRICS remarks or Indonesia sanctions-purchase reports flagged as single-sourced last issue; both remain unconfirmed and are not repeated in detail.

IRAN & HORMUZ

The market mechanics of Monday's failed Salalah meeting are in the Lead; the substance of what was actually being postponed is more specific than "shipping talks." Iran and Oman reached a bilateral route-map agreement in late August: an entry route into the Gulf and part of an exit route both run through Iranian territorial waters, with the pre-war southern route to close once the new system takes effect. Monday's Salalah meeting was billed as Oman and Iran briefing

Saudi Arabia, the UAE, Qatar, Kuwait and non-GCC Iraq on that already-negotiated map — not a from-scratch negotiation — which makes Saudi Arabia's request to postpone read less as walking away from diplomacy and more as refusing to bless a route plan while Iran-aligned Houthi forces keep striking Saudi soil. At least one outlet characterized the postponement as indefinite rather than merely rescheduled; no new date has been confirmed. Separately, the Sept. 12 strike on a vessel off Limah, Oman and the unexplained dark tanker spotted nearby remain unresolved — no attribution confirmed by any party. This issue is not repeating the early-September US-Iran tanker-strike exchange (three Iranian tankers hit by the US, Iranian ballistic-missile fire at US Navy vessels) in detail; nothing new on that episode was located this run, and it predates this issue's coverage window.

SPORTS

Yankees	Beat Twins 8-3 Mon. 9/14 (Judge 3-run HR, six-run 8th) — clinched AL playoff berth. 87-63.
Knicks	Hart extension still unsigned; front office reportedly favors a smaller deal than his max.
Northwestern	Bye week; hosts Colorado Sat. 9/19, 6:30p CT.

Continuity. Dropped as unchanged since Saturday: Nvidia-Hugging Face deal terms (\$12.93B, closing H1 2027); Amazon FTC ad-auction suit; Ford/CATL battery scrutiny; Anthropic's own IPO timeline (still no S-1 — distinct from Altman's OpenAI 2026 comment above). Watch for next issue: Wednesday's FOMC decision, dot plot and whether the Waller/Williams skepticism shows up as recorded dissents; whether Salalah talks get rescheduled; independent confirmation of the Sept. 14 Saudi pipeline incident and the Sept. 12 Limah strike's attribution; further Navier-Stokes corroboration from either side; Starship Flight 14's Sept. 22 window holding; Lennar's Wednesday print against a -35% y/y EPS consensus on the same day as the Fed.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.